SOC INCIDENT INVESTIGATION REPORT

PHISHING ALERT - DECEPTIVE MAIL DETECTED

1. Incident Overview

Incident Title	Phishing Alert - Deceptive Mail Detected
Date	May 06, 2026
Severity	Medium
Analyst	SOC Analyst
Status	**True Positive (Closed)**

2. Alert Summary

The SIEM platform generated an alert (Rule: SOC282) regarding a deceptive email detected within the environment. The detection identified characteristics of a phishing attempt aimed at delivering a suspicious domain or link to an internal user inbox. Investigation confirmed the threat and assessed the delivery status.

3. Initial Indicators of Compromise (IOCs)

IOC Type	Value
Threat Type	Deceptive Phishing Email
Event ID	257
Delivery Status	Delivered
Primary Indicator	Suspicious domain/link identified in 'Email Security'

4. Investigation Steps

Step 1: Alert Validation

- Reviewed SIEM alert details for Event ID 257

- Confirmed rule "SOC282 - Deceptive Mail Detected" was correctly triggered.

Step 2: Email and Log Analysis

- **Logs Reviewed:** Email security logs and delivery report.
- **Findings:** Email was successfully delivered to the user inbox.
- **Indicators:** Identified suspicious sender behavior and phishing links.

Step 3: Correlation

- Correlated email delivery status with the alert timestamp (May 13, 2024, 09:22 AM).
- Identified characteristics associated with credential-harvesting phishing attempts.

Step 4: Impact Assessment

- Conducted checks to determine if the user opened the malicious file or URL.
- Evaluated potential user exposure due to successful delivery.

5. Root Cause Analysis

The incident was triggered by a deceptive email containing phishing-related indicators that reached the user's inbox. The activity is likely a targeted attempt to trick the recipient into interacting with malicious content or revealing sensitive information.

6. Containment Actions

Action	Status
Email Delivery Verified	Completed
Link/URL Analysis	Completed
Threat Assessment	Completed

7. Final Assessment

The incident is classified as a **True Positive**. Investigation confirmed the email reached the recipient, increasing risk exposure. While no immediate compromise was identified during the review, continued monitoring is recommended.

8. Escalation Decision

Decision	Reason
Closed as True Positive	Email successfully delivered with phishing indicators.

9. Lessons Learned

- Users should be trained to identify suspicious emails and deceptive links.
- Email filtering mechanisms should be continuously improved to block identified indicators.
- Delivered phishing emails must be investigated promptly to reduce overall risk.